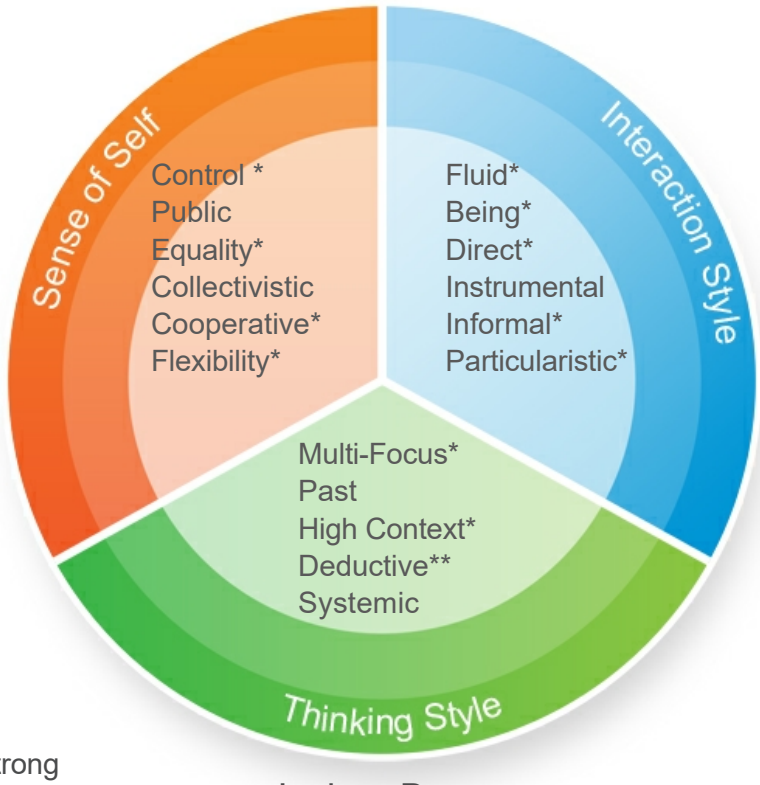
My COI Report



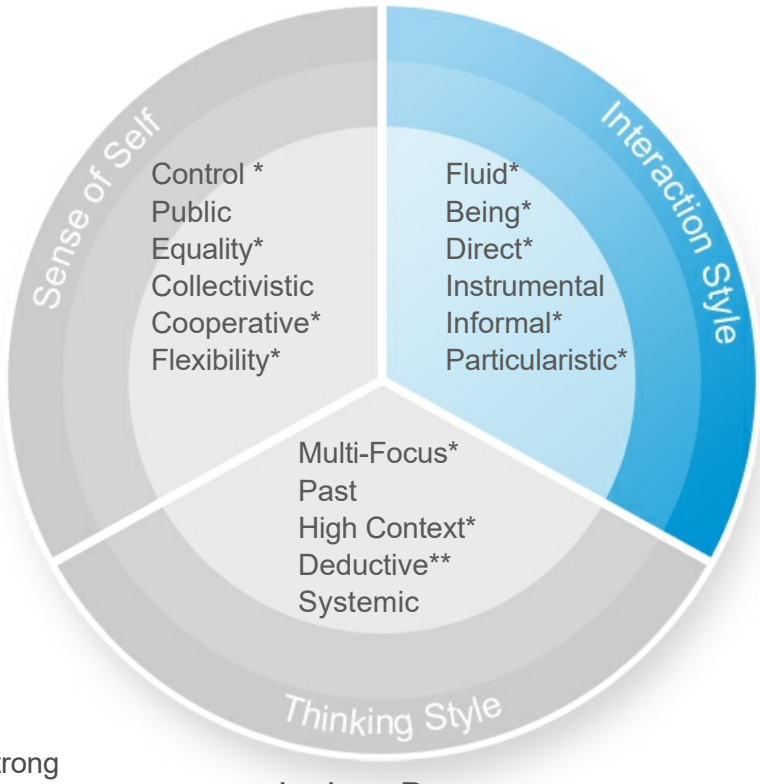
* Strong

** Very Strong

Joshua Bruce

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.

Interaction Style



* Strong
** Very Strong

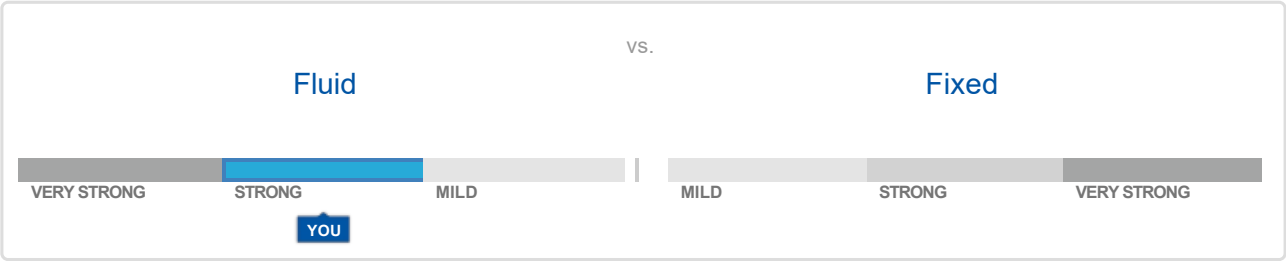
Joshua Bruce

How people tend to communicate and engage with others in work situations

Your Interaction Style results suggest that you tend to prefer the following:

- Using schedules as negotiable guidelines and managing time loosely (Fluid)
- Focusing more on building trusting relationships and planning than on accomplishing tasks and taking action (Being)
- Handling conflict and giving feedback straightforwardly (Direct)
- Communicating in a dispassionate and pragmatic way in work situations (Instrumental)
- Taking a more casual and relaxed approach to business situations (Informal)
- Making exceptions to rules and standards based on the circumstances (Particularistic)

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You experience time as a flexible and relative process, rather than as fixed, absolute, and precise. You recognize time as an important framework for life's events, but do not feel the need to control and manage it precisely. You do not believe that time can or should be tightly defined and tracked. Instead, you focus on what happens within time, and you let situations and events rather than schedules determine your course of action. Particularly, addressing the relationships with the people with whom you are interacting and the tasks with which you are involved are important to you.

You tend to see timelines and deadlines as expressions of intent but do not feel bound by them during work processes and events. Process flow and the completion of activities are more important to you than adherence to specific timelines and schedules. Process requirements determine your actions and activities. Situations in which schedules and punctuality are overriding concerns are highly frustrating to you.

Challenges

Your strong fluid-time orientation indicates that you tend to relate to time as a flexible and negotiable resource, focusing less on timelines and time commitments. In general, you find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more fixed-oriented handling of time, in which punctuality is strictly defined, and timelines are considered binding.

When working with people who have fixed-time orientations, you may:

- Experience them as rigid and inflexible.
- Feel that the perception of timelines and schedules is unrealistic.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Focus on punctuality and following timelines exactly.
- Develop behavioral routines and adopt time management practices that enable meeting deadlines more precisely.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong fluid-time orientations, you may:

- Feel a strong affinity for how they relate to and negotiate timelines and deadlines.
- Perceive them as sometimes overemphasizing the requirements of situations, circumstances, and relationships.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Highlight the need to more seriously consider time constraints in addition to other goals.
- Evaluate the advantages and disadvantages of your shared valuing of time as a negotiable resource.

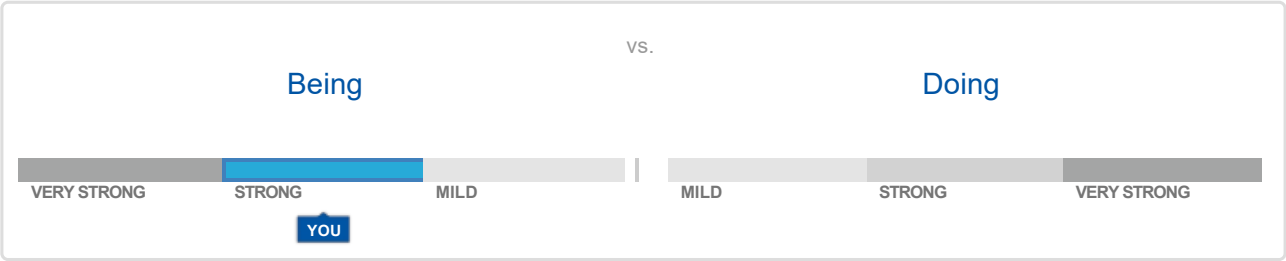
When working with people who have mild fluid-time orientations, you may:

- Feel that they can sometimes be overly concerned with timeliness.
- Perceive them at times as too focused on deadlines.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Work more on following schedules and meeting deadlines.
- Avoid viewing a focus on timelines as a lack of understanding about the importance of quality and/or relationships.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You emphasize building and maintaining good relationships with those around you in your business interactions. You are motivated by interpersonal relations and expect that building such relationships is an important condition for accomplishing tasks and achieving business success. You readily invest in creating trusting relationships, as it is a function of time, experience with others, and incremental self-disclosure. You prefer to surround yourself with a permanent group of trusted individuals. When meeting new people in business, you require a relatively long "warm-up" period because you are careful not to extend trust too quickly. It is important for you that individuals establish their credibility and reliability.

Before taking action, you need time to contemplate and reflect. You tend to scrutinize issues carefully. You do not jump to conclusions or take action quickly or lightly, and you feel it is important that decisions are well founded and well grounded. The expedient accomplishment of tasks is secondary to building trust and rapport with business colleagues. Business interactions that assume a level of trust immediately in order to quickly proceed to action seem to you questionable and ineffective.

Challenges

Your strong being orientation indicates that you pay attention to building and maintaining trusting relationships and to making plans in work situations. You generally find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more action- and task-oriented work style, in which the quality of relationships is secondary.

When working with people who have doing orientations, you may:

- Experience them as abrupt, cold, uncaring, insensitive, or tactless.
- Believe that they overlook the importance and intricacies of building and maintaining trust and relationships.
- Become irritated by rushed decision-making based on incomplete information and without consideration of stakeholder perspectives.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Increase your comfort level with making decisions and determining actions based on limited and/or incomplete information.
- Assume that trust already exists and may not be built over a long period of time.
- Focus on tasks and de-emphasize relationship building.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong being orientations, you may:

- Feel a strong affinity with their overall approach to business relationships and decision-making.
- Believe that the decision-making process can take too long at times.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Evaluate the advantages and disadvantages of your shared preference for relationship building.
- Assess the propensity for comparatively slow trust-building and decision-making processes, especially for short-term projects and/or clearly transactional situations.

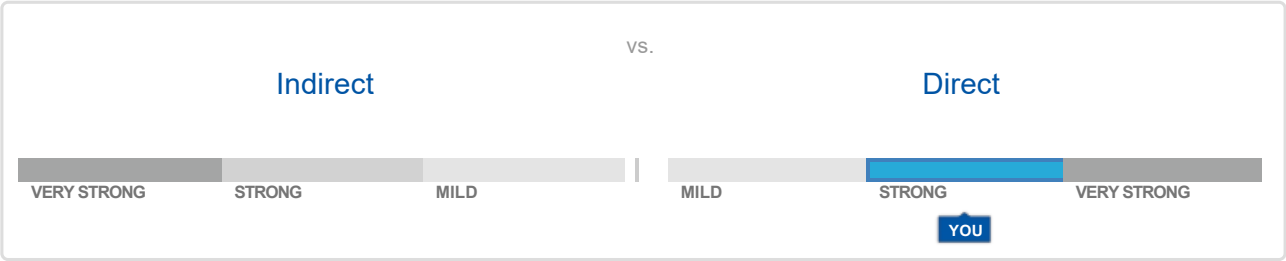
When working with people who have mild being orientations, you may:

- Feel that they sometimes do not fully appreciate the importance of building work relationships before extending trust.
- Be perceived as lacking flexibility and responsiveness due to your preference for relatively slow decision-making processes.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Engage in business relationships with people whom you do not know well when necessary.
- Learn to make timely decisions with less focus on information and consultation.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You prefer to handle conflicts in an open and straightforward manner. You tend to see conflict situations as impersonal issues that need to be addressed openly and face-to-face to reach resolution. Conflict, disagreements, and dissent are often regarded as positive and constructive for direct communicators. For you, direct conflict management is intricately tied to the notion of honesty and trustworthiness.

Generally, you are not deeply disturbed when tensions run high. You view open conflict as constructive and appreciate the benefits of bringing contentious issues into the open so they can be resolved in a timely manner. Situations that require an implicit or indirect form of conflict handling (i.e., mediation) are frustrating to you.

Challenges

Your strong direct orientation indicates that you prefer a more direct approach to handling conflict at work. You generally find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more indirect style, in which being tactful and saving face are key concerns.

When working with people who have indirect orientations, you may:

- Experience their concern with saving face and avoiding open disagreement as unproductive and disingenuous.
- Become frustrated by a lack of clear indicators of conflict or embarrassment that they experience.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Take care to avoid directly confronting business associates who may be embarrassed by it.
- Increase your comfort with indirect conflict-resolution strategies.
- Use cultural dialogue to develop conflict-handling norms proactively.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong direct orientations, you may:

- Be rather comfortable with open disagreements.
- Find their ways of handling conflict somewhat aggressive at times.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Be even more direct in conflict situations with those individuals.
- Raise awareness of the importance of handling conflict in a way that is appropriate to the situation.

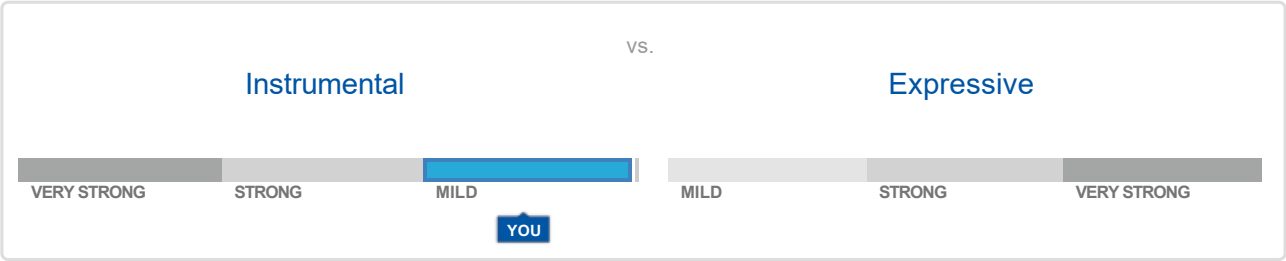
When working with people who have mild direct orientations, you may:

- Feel that their ways of addressing issues and giving feedback can be weak and ineffective at times.
- Be perceived occasionally as contentious and lacking tact.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Understand the value of a less direct approach.
- Avoid interpreting sensitivity to saving face as an indicator of poor conflict handling.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You place an emphasis on accuracy, control, discipline, and emotional neutrality in business interactions. You value factual, objective, and pragmatic exchanges of information and have a low tolerance for emotional displays in the work environment. For you, communication is problem- or issue-centered, impersonal, and goal-oriented.

You often see work relationships as qualitatively different from social ones. As a result, you evaluate individuals at work on the basis of their direct and measurable contributions. You prefer an emotionally detached way of presenting information in order to convince others of your points. Emotional expressiveness in others may cause you to doubt their professionalism, credibility, and trustworthiness in business. Work environments that encourage an open display of emotions and/or eloquent and stylistic use of language can be irritating for you.

Challenges

Your mild instrumental orientation indicates that you are rather flexible in how you react to various communication and presentation styles. While you prefer a style that is neutral, matter-of-fact, and pragmatic in work situations, you also find it easy to style-switch and accommodate a more expressive style, which emphasizes emotional connection and expressing viewpoints with eloquence.

When working with people who have mild expressive orientations, you may:

- Minimize the differences inherent in your respective preferred ways of persuading others to your points of view.
- Be unprepared to deal with the impact of differences in how much emotion you prefer in communications, particularly in stressful situations.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Be aware of the subtle ways in which differences in cultural preferences may become apparent.
- Build on your ability to easily style-switch and willingness to compromise to improve your work relationships.

When working with people who have strong or very strong expressive orientations, you may:

- Experience their emotion-centered style as lacking seriousness and professional credibility at times.
- Feel that the constant ebb and flow of emotions is tiresome and demotivating.
- Find the emphasis on style and eloquence unnecessary or distracting.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Avoid associating your notions of professionalism with emotional detachment.
- Increase your appreciation for the role that style and eloquence play in business contexts.
- Develop your style-switching capabilities to shift to a more expressive interaction style as a means to build rapport, credibility, and effective relationships.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

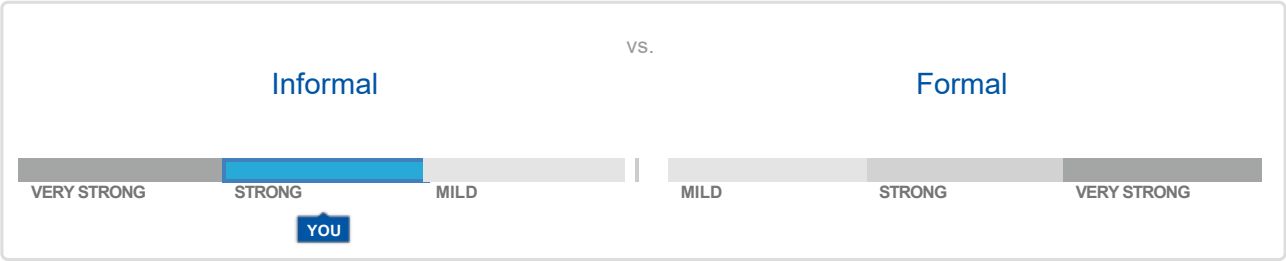
When working with people who have strong or very strong instrumental orientations, you may:

- Find their communication style too detached, disengaging, and impersonal at times.
- Perceive them as overlooking the importance of sharing emotions and connecting personally in the workplace.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Limit your own use of emotion when appropriate.
- Accept that they may view a seemingly extreme level of emotional detachment as an indicator of professionalism.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You prefer a more informal interaction style when communicating in business situations. You tend to experience formality more as a barrier to a free flow of opinions and thoughts and the creation of productive business relationships. You emphasize flexibility, spontaneity, and dispensing with protocol to establish positive work and business relationships. For you, credibility, sincerity, and trustworthiness are tied to a friendly and jovial style.

You value casual, relaxed, and friendly conduct in the workplace and business situations and view it as conducive to good communication and problem solving. You see formalities, social conventions, and customs as unnecessary and as insurmountable barriers to good communication. You feel alienated and excluded by those who maintain social distance from you through the use of rules and decorum, particularly in business environments where you are required to adhere to protocol and social conventions. For you, observing etiquette, decorum, and tradition seems to establish an undesirable distance between people.

Challenges

Your strong informal orientation indicates that you prefer a more informal approach in business communications. You generally find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more formal communication style, in which etiquette, protocol, and established patterns of interactions are more important.

When working with people who have formal orientations, you may:

- Experience them as too rigid and distant in business communications.
- Feel that they disregard the importance of effective relationships, personal connections, and authenticity.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Appreciate the usefulness, value, and social significance of formal behavior.
- Familiarize yourself with the rules of etiquette and protocol.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong informal orientations, you may:

- Find their approach to business relationships extremely relaxed and casual.
- Be unconcerned with what others perceive as transgressions over relationship boundaries.
- Associate their high degree of informality with authenticity.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Increase your comfort with interactions that are even more casual.
- Indicate when a somewhat more formal approach may be more appropriate.

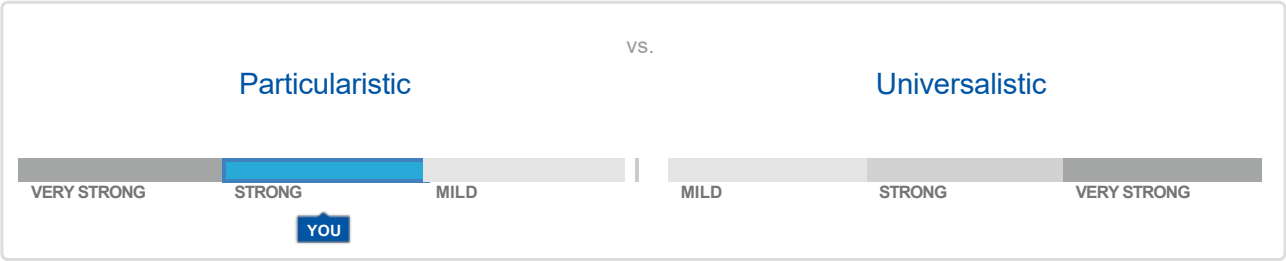
When working with people who have mild informal orientations, you may:

- Feel that they occasionally do not adequately value a relaxed and casual approach to business interactions.
- Be perceived as somewhat disrespectful or unprofessional in some situations.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Increase your comfort in situations where you are required to take a somewhat more formal approach.
- Avoid interpreting social conventions as unnecessary impediments to the flow of communication or as barriers to authenticity.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You find rules and principles useful as guidelines and value the ability to make exceptions or "bend the rule." Acknowledging the uniqueness of people, situations, and circumstances is important to you. It is important to you to be recognized by others as unique. Trust in and obligations to those in your network tend to determine your decisions. You are loyal to the people in your network and expect loyalty from them in return.

You interact differentially, according to the individual and unique circumstances and relationships in a given situation. You value and encourage uniqueness and the careful consideration of particular circumstances. You value the ability to adapt your behavior and approach to the requirements of the situation. You tend to view norms, rules, and procedures as expressions of intent and loose guidelines, but you may not feel bound by them.

Challenges

Your strong particularistic orientation indicates that you value a situational approach and favor case-by-case consideration of circumstances in work situations. In general, you find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate some degree of universalism, which is associated with rule- or principle-based handling of people and situations.

When working with people who have universalistic orientations, you may:

- Experience them as rigid, mechanistic, and unrealistic.
- Be perceived as disrespectful and obstructive because you seem to refuse to follow the rules.
- Be considered lacking discipline and/or consistent standards for fairness.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Understand the importance of uniform standards for universalistic individuals.
- Place greater trust in uniform standards, procedures, and rules.
- Develop your ability to style-switch and base your behavior and treatment of others on uniform standards.
- Consider equality rather than equity as a standard for fair treatment of others.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong particularistic orientations, you may:

- View some of the exceptions and preferential treatment for specific individuals as excessive.
- Feel that situational exceptions can be inappropriate and counterproductive at times.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Further enhance your focus on and appreciation of the unique and particular circumstances of a given situation.
- Seek out exceptions to norms, rules, or procedures.

When working with people who have mild particularistic orientations, you may:

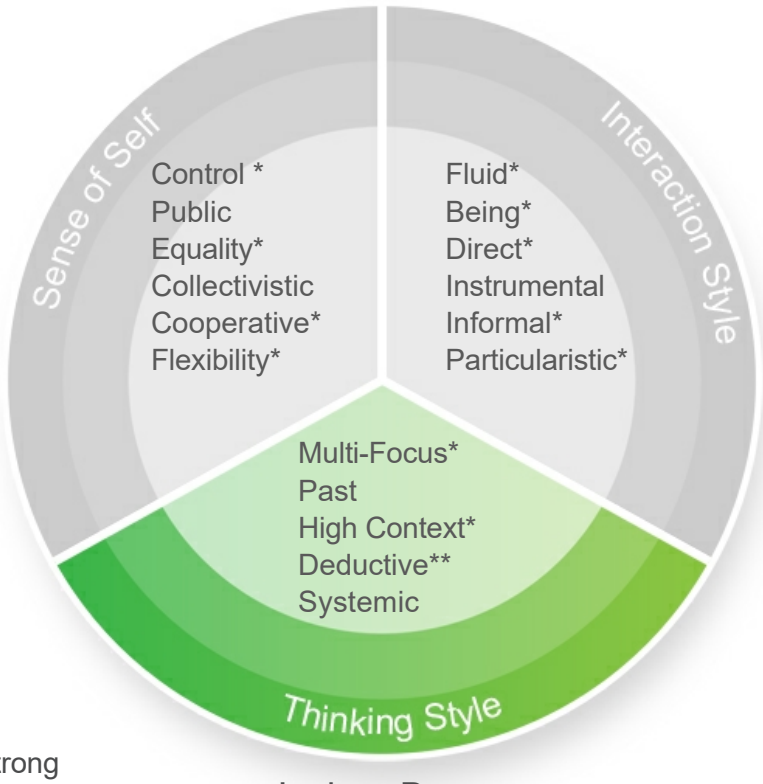
- Feel that they do not always take into account the specific circumstances of a situation.
- Be perceived as eccentric and showing favoritism if you change or circumvent the rules for particular individuals.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Increase your patience for rules and standards.
- Be more willing to limit preferential treatment for individuals.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.

Thinking Style



* Strong

** Very Strong

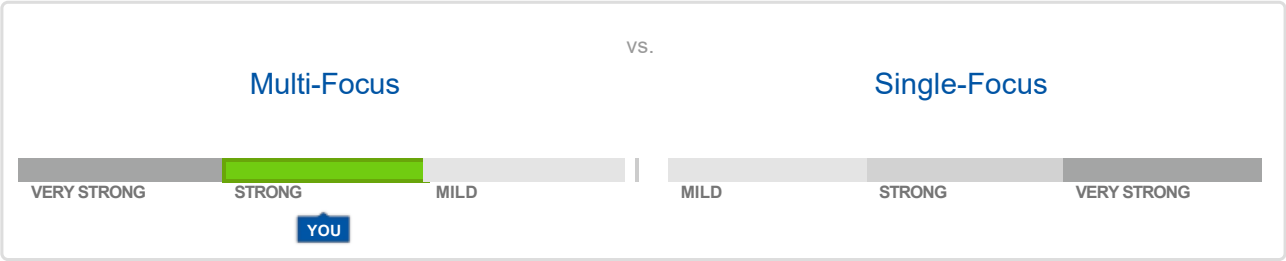
Joshua Bruce

How people tend to process information in work situations

Your Thinking Style results suggest that you tend to prefer the following:

- Focusing on and taking in information from multiple sources simultaneously (Multi-Focus)
- Analyzing problems and making decisions based on continuity with the past and traditional ways of doing things (Past)
- Sending and interpreting messages based on implicit nonverbal and situational cues (High Context)
- Analyzing theories and focusing on general concepts before moving to the specific details (Deductive)
- Structuring thoughts and solutions based on a "big picture" view of a problem or presentation and how the parts are interconnected (Systemic)

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You tend to process different types of information simultaneously and in a parallel manner. You focus on various tasks, inputs, and/or relationships at the same time. You value dynamism in your environment and easily adapt to changes - you even welcome them. You are not likely to be disturbed by unpredictable and unscheduled events.

Situations that require you to process information sequentially and focus on one task and/or relationship at a time can make you uncomfortable or irritated. You tend to be easily bored when you are asked to concentrate on one issue exclusively.

Challenges

Your strong multi-focus orientation indicates that you much prefer to focus your attention, take in information, and approach tasks through multiple elements at a time. You generally find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more single-focused approach, which values focusing on one task at a time and processing information in a sequential manner.

When working with people who have single-focus orientations, you may:

- Become bored and feel inefficient when asked to focus on one issue at a time.
- Be perceived as disrespectful by people who expect you to give them your full attention.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Increase your comfort with focusing on one issue or problem at a time.
- Limit the number of changes you introduce at a given time.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong multi-focus orientations, you may:

- Perceive them sometimes as too unfocused.
- Become frustrated by what you see as a lack of focus on critical details.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Use your ability to focus on and present multiple sources of information more extensively.
- Expand your multi-focused approach to information to improve decision-making and efficiency.

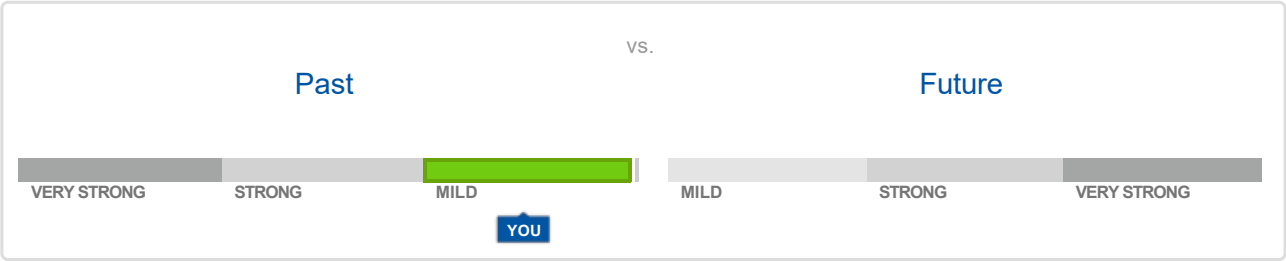
When working with people who have mild multi-focus orientations, you may:

- Find their ability to focus on multiple tasks and/or relationships at one time inadequate.
- Be perceived as scattered and ineffective at times.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Try to organize and structure processes and workflow more clearly when appropriate.
- Evaluate the assumption that focusing on multiple sources of information simultaneously improves decision-making and efficiency.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

Reference to and continuity with the past are important to you, and your problem analysis and decision-making is guided by the need for continuity, consistency, stability, and precedent. You look to the past as a model for your present and future challenges, options, and choices. You tend to either follow traditional ways of doing things or reinstate or counteract past conditions. You tend to dislike opportunistic decision-making or visions of a radically different future, disconnected from past conditions.

You tend to judge plans and changes according to whether or not they adhere to traditional ways of doing things. You have an intuitive sense of the importance of history and value the achievements of previous generations. You may experience change as threatening. Generally, you are not easily intrigued by novelties and require a relatively long period of time to assess and evaluate situations and opportunities. For you, precedents and past successes are important in solving problems, and your decision-making is primarily guided by distinct historical references and experiences.

Challenges

Your mild past orientation indicates that you are somewhat flexible in the ways you interpret situations, approach problems, and determine the criteria for solutions. While you tend to rely on the past and precedents, you frequently are guided by pragmatic considerations of the present circumstances. This pragmatism enables you to easily style-switch to a future orientation, which seeks change and innovative solutions toward a future that can differ greatly from the past.

When working with people who have mild future orientations, you may:

- Minimize the subtle differences inherent in your respective approaches and perspectives on the past and future.
- Be unprepared to deal with the impact of differences in the value you place on past or future considerations, particularly in stressful situations.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Explore the subtle ways in which differences in your respective cultural preferences impact your thinking and perceptions.
- Increase your awareness of how the differences in your orientations can affect your attitudes and actions.

When working with people who have strong or very strong future orientations, you may:

- Experience them as too idealistic.
- Be uncomfortable with their willingness to take risks with unproven plans or ideas.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Practice future-oriented planning.
- Evaluate the advantages of new practices in a nonjudgmental manner.
- Experiment with change, even with proven processes.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

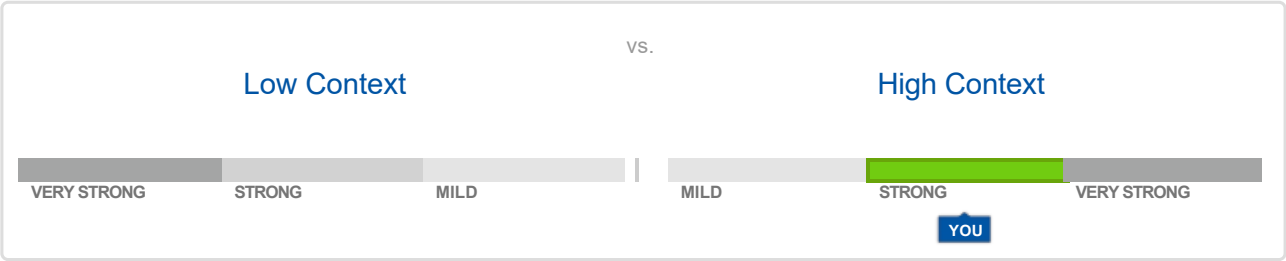
When working with people who have strong or very strong past orientations, you may:

- Find them somewhat "stuck" in the past.
- Feel that they lack imagination and/or adaptability.

To address these concerns, you may want to:

- Explore the significance of history and continuity for these individuals.
- Anchor creativity, imagination, and adaptability by referring to historical precedents in which such qualities were important.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You rely on a wide array of situational components and contextual information to interpret and communicate meaning. Consequently, you scan situations and information for cues and deeper levels of meaning and significance. You value artful, metaphoric, and/or symbolic expressions of meaning. You are sensitive to a wide array of situational and contextual components from which to extract and infer the true meaning and message. You assume that real meaning is implicit and lies beyond what is readily apparent or presented to you.

You rely on nonverbal, symbolic, and situational cues more than on verbal and written cues. In order to get work done, you require a lot of contextual information about those with whom you are communicating and/or conducting business. You rely on inferences and careful analysis to derive meaning and expect the same of others. You may find situations that require you to be explicit and literal frustrating.

Challenges

Your strong high-context orientation indicates that you tend to prefer and rely on implicit meaning and contextual cues when you read and interpret meaning. You generally find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more low-context approach, which focuses on explicit and literal interpretation of meaning.

When working with people who have low-context orientations, you may:

- Perceive their way of reading and interpreting information as too simplistic, confusing, and/or possibly unreliable.
- Experience some frustration with what you view as their inability to understand context and cues.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Limit your reliance on situational cues, including nonverbal cues, to carry essential meaning.
- Avoid interpreting their low-context approach as impolite or unreliable.
- Assume that what is explicitly stated is what is meant.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong high-context orientations, you may:

- Experience them as too vague and unspecific at times, particularly when their understanding of the meanings of nonverbal cues and situational variables differs from yours.
- Misinterpret or over-interpret the meaning behind what they say.
- Feel that they are at risk of interpreting situations and information erroneously.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Pay more attention to context and nonverbal cues.
- Seek to understand the meaning of contextual, situational, and nonverbal cues for them.
- Assume that what is stated is not always what is meant.
- Use cultural dialogue to clarify the meaning of frequent cues and implicit signals when deriving meaning.

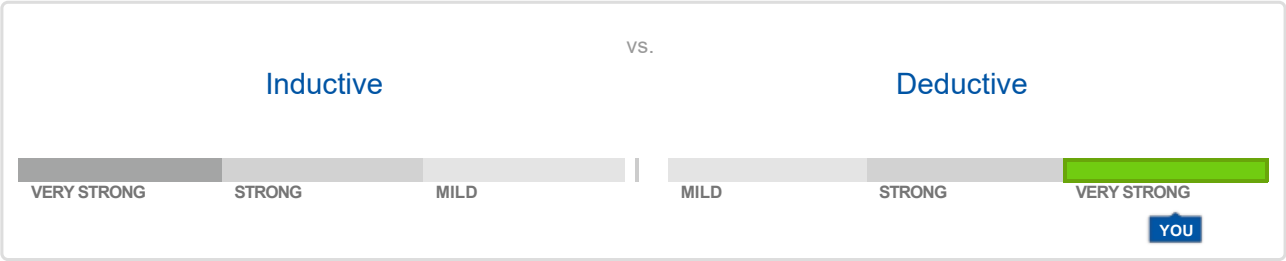
When working with people who have mild high-context orientations, you may:

- Feel they sometimes lack understanding of and appreciation for context and nonverbal cues as carriers of key information.
- Be perceived as too focused on “hidden meaning” or subtleties at times.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Explain the meaning behind your communications when needed.
- Be more explicit when necessary.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

As a deductive thinker, you learn best and introduce new ideas by focusing on concepts, theories, and principles first, rather than on specific details and situations. You tend to scrutinize and debate conceptual frameworks and key principles before applying them to particular scenarios. Situations that require a case-by-case analysis of details without discussion of the overall principles can be irritating and frustrating to you.

You tend to evaluate the quality and soundness of a presentation and proposal based on the concepts upon which they rest. Once a conceptual framework is sufficiently developed or apparent, you apply it to specific situations and/or circumstances. You get frustrated when the conceptual foundation is not readily apparent or sufficiently developed.

Challenges

Your very strong deductive orientation indicates that you tend to rely on abstract logic, theories, and principles to organize and make sense of data when you reason, make inferences, structure arguments, and approach learning. You generally find it very difficult to style-switch to accommodate a more inductive approach and rely primarily on details and data to anchor learning and reasoning.

When working with people who have inductive orientations, you may:

- Become irritated or overwhelmed by too many details.
- Perceive them as lacking the ability to adequately interpret and make sense of data and details.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Develop patience with a less abstract approach to data and reasoning.
- Resist “fitting” data into a theory.
- Pay greater attention to raw data and detail.
- Learn to value case studies and anecdotes in some contexts.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

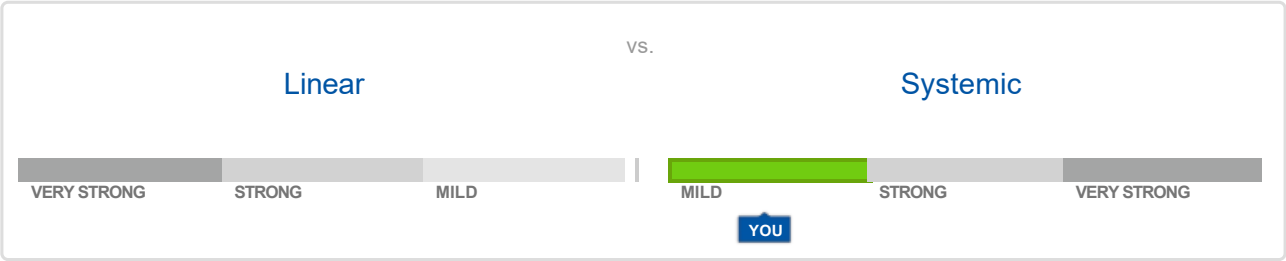
When working with people who have mild or strong deductive orientations, you may:

- Dismiss the value they may occasionally place on case studies and anecdotes.
- Feel that their ability to analyze data based on abstract logic is lacking at times.
- Be perceived as “fitting” data into theory in some cases.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Enhance your appreciation of data and case studies.
- Increase your willingness to learn from illustrations and anecdotes.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You focus on a holistic "big-picture" view when confronted with a particular situation, problem, or challenge. You tend to focus on relationships between concepts or components of a situation and examine its systemic and complex interactions and interconnections. In order to persuade others to accept a proposition or argument, you point out the likely impact and effect on related variables.

Being mindful of the complexity and interrelatedness of issues is a hallmark of realism for you. Situations or circumstances that require you to break down complex phenomena into discrete cause-effect relationships and analyzing their component parts and examining each independently can be frustrating to you.

Challenges

Your mild systemic orientation indicates that you are somewhat flexible in the ways you approach problems, structure your thinking, and frame solutions. While you tend prefer a “big-picture” perspective and focus on the systemic relationships of component parts, you also find it easy to style-switch and accommodate a more linear approach, which values a sequential analysis of separate parts linked together by a cause-and-effect relationship.

When working with people who have mild linear orientations, you may:

- Minimize the differences inherent in your respective preferences for approaching problems and structuring at work.
- Be unprepared to deal with the impact of differences in how you prefer to structure your thinking, particularly in stressful situations.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Be aware of the subtle ways in which differences in cultural preferences may become apparent.
- Build on your ability to easily style-switch and willingness to compromise to improve your work relationships.

When working with people who have strong or very strong linear orientations, you may:

- Perceive their problem-solving approach as too simplistic.
- Feel that they seem to be missing important linkages to the “big picture.”

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- De-emphasize the “big picture” and the interrelatedness of components.
- Concentrate on the details of individual components.
- Focus more on crafting solutions that outline, order, and sequence discrete elements.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have strong or very strong systemic orientations, you may:

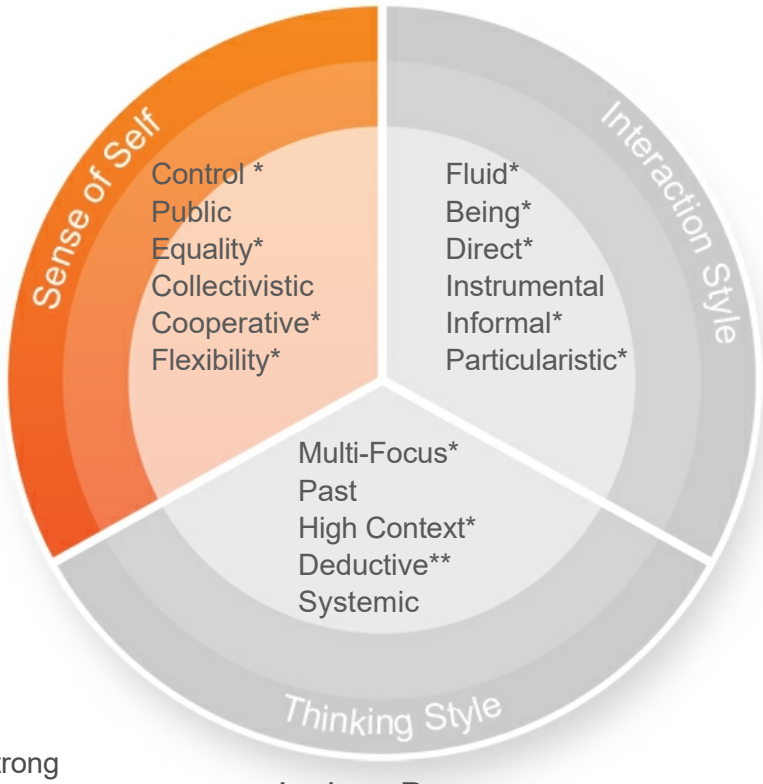
- Feel that they are too focused on the “big picture” at times.
- Believe that they sometimes dismiss or overlook the importance of understanding specific components in more detail.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Enhance your capability for a holistic intake of information.
- Increase your appreciation for complexity and systems.
- Place an even greater emphasis on a system-oriented approach to understanding problems and seeking solutions that recognizes interdependencies.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.

Sense of Self



* Strong
** Very Strong

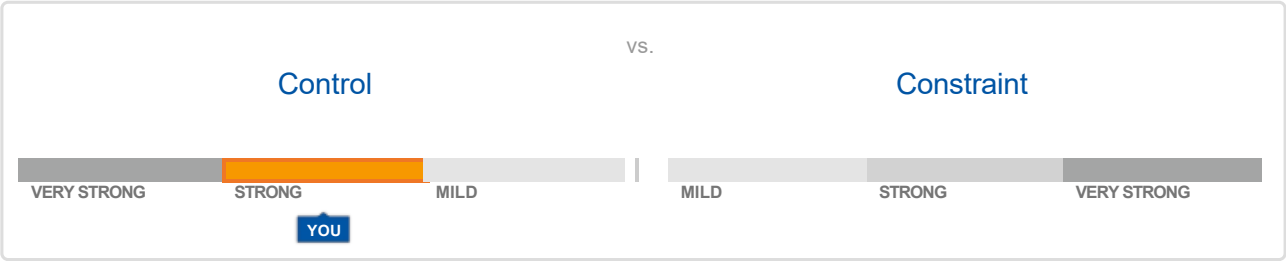
Joshua Bruce

How people tend to view identity and motivation in work situations

Your Sense of Self results suggest that you tend to prefer the following:

- Bringing a sense of empowerment to your work environment (Control)
- Having open spaces that foster accessibility and information sharing on a nice-to-know basis (Public)
- Working in environments with equal treatment and minimized status differences (Equality)
- Identifying as a member of an interdependent group in work situations (Collectivistic)
- Being motivated by mutually satisfactory business relationships (Cooperative)
- Fostering risk, uncertainty, and ambiguity in work situations (Flexibility)

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You approach your workplace with a sense of empowerment. You tend to be proactive and self-driven, and you readily take initiative to change undesirable circumstances. When you encounter obstacles, limitations, and challenges, you look for solutions and identify changes and action plans.

Your control orientation indicates that you often assume that objects and people in your work environment should conform to your preferred approach, methods, and processes. You tend to assert your point of view and expect others to do the same. You prefer to take charge of situations and do not shy away from conflict and risk. In some cases, you may become irritated with people who do not seem actively engaged in problem solving, do not share your sense of priorities, or seem to lack initiative.

Challenges

Your strong control orientation indicates that you bring a strong sense of empowerment to work situations. You tend to assume that you can and should change circumstances to fit your needs. In general, you find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a constraint-oriented mindset, which values staying within established boundaries and guidelines.

When working with people who have constraint orientations, you may:

- Be perceived as aggressive and/or confrontational.
- Assume that you will lead and direct in most situations.
- Become easily frustrated and impatient with what you perceive as a lack of empowerment, engagement, and willingness to take charge.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Approach new situations more carefully and slowly.
- Develop patience with a more constraint-oriented perspective.
- Phase in your initiatives and contributions incrementally.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have strong or very strong control orientations, you may:

- Experience conflict if their ideas about how to address challenges and changes do not fit yours.
- Compete for control with others who also try to take charge or initiative.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Engage in creative problem solving together.
- Minimize your wish to take charge of situations.
- Accept suggestions that do not fit your ideas of necessary change.

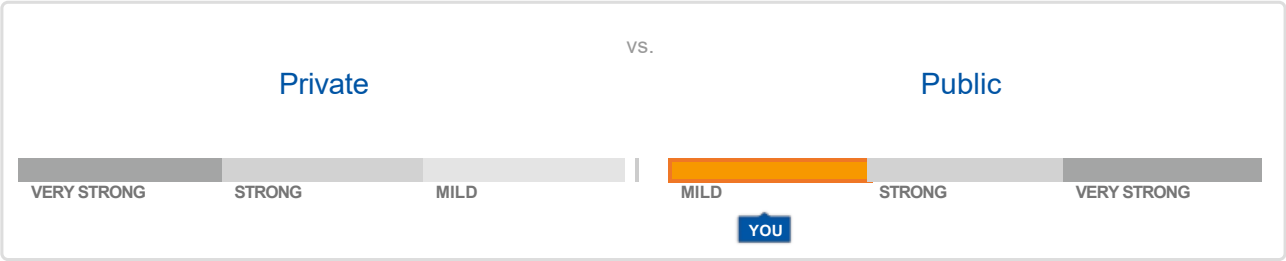
When working with people who have mild control orientations, you may:

- Find them too cautious and tentative in embracing the advantages of bold changes.
- Feel that they too easily compromise on change efforts, in negotiations, and/or conflict situations.
- Believe that they are too concerned with the impact of bold changes on people and relationships.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Be more willing to compromise on certain issues.
- Appreciate the merits of a more cautious and conciliatory approach.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You prefer minimal boundaries and demarcations in the workplace and value business interactions that foster closeness and accessibility between you and your colleagues. You tend to be more comfortable in office spaces that group people together in one large room and that require daily interaction and a sharing of resources. When communicating, you may prefer to stand closer to others.

You prefer to share information on a good-to-know or nice-to-know basis with those members who belong to your team or social group at work. You prefer work environments that are tolerant of open-door meetings with frequent interruptions and that foster a relationship-oriented approach to communicating to others. You are most comfortable with situations that enhance the development of trust and rapport and therefore prefer face-to-face meetings or the informal exchange of information between people.

Challenges

Your mild public orientation indicates that you are rather flexible in how you perceive space, both in a physical and psychological sense. While you value and expect open spaces in the workplace, where barriers or “distance” is minimized, you also find it easy to style-switch and accommodate a more private approach to space, which values boundaries.

When working with people who have mild private orientations, you may:

- Minimize the differences inherent in your respective preferences for minimized or maximized personal space at work.
- Be unprepared to deal with the impact of differences in how you perceive physical and psychological space in your work environment, particularly in stressful situations.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Be aware of the subtle ways in which differences in cultural preferences may become apparent.
- Build on your ability to easily style-switch and willingness to compromise to improve your work relationships.

When working with people who have strong or very strong private orientations, you may:

- Perceive them as secretive and inaccessible.
- Feel that physical distance seems like a barrier to the open flow of information and easy accessibility for planning, decision-making, and communication.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Develop the skill of revealing information gradually.
- Understand the markers that distinguish public domains and behaviors from private ones.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

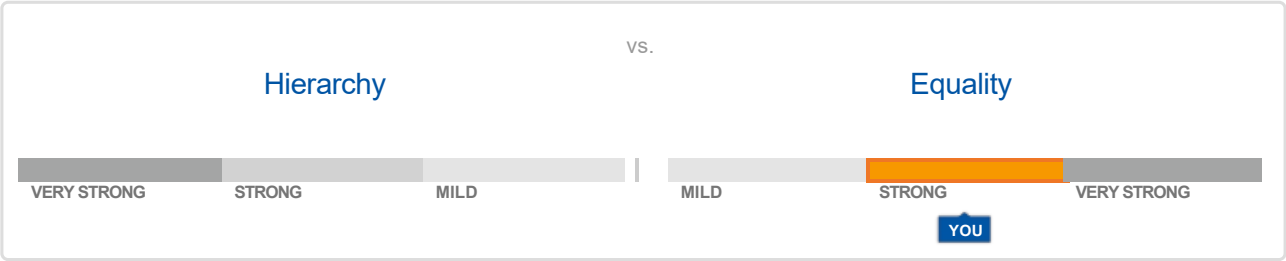
When working with people who have strong or very strong public orientations, you may:

- Find the ready and open availability of information counterproductive at times.
- Feel that they sometimes trespass on your personal space.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Learn to disclose and share information more freely.
- Increase your comfort level with physical contact and proximity to others.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You value equality in both your perspective on business relationships and interactions in the workplace and organization. You strive to minimize power differentials and their appearance and assume that everyone has the same essential value, rights, responsibilities, and social status. As a result, you prefer to equalize the status of everyone in the organization. It is important to you that everyone is included and has the same opportunities, so you tend to be sensitive to the needs of everyone in a situation. Situations where there is an open show of deference and respect and where formal lines of authority are demarcated tend to be uncomfortable for you.

You tend to downplay, minimize, or even hide economic and social differences both at work and in your personal life. It is acceptable for you to bypass formal lines of authority in order to get things done. You may also feel uneasy and irritated by official titles and forms of address that reinforce hierarchical structures. You generally prefer to work within a "flat" organizational structure.

Challenges

Your strong equality orientation indicates that you value and expect egalitarian relationships and seek to reduce power differentials in your workplace and business relationships. You generally find it very difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more hierarchical approach.

When working with people who have hierarchy orientations, you may:

- Be perceived as rude, disrespectful, and/or lacking in social graces.
- Feel that they hinder openness, honesty, and effective communication.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Learn to understand the importance of authority and power distance to hierarchical individuals.
- Develop tolerance for what you may perceive as excessive deference in your work environment.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong equality orientations, you may:

- Feel that you lack clear understanding of your status and role at times.
- Find them sometimes lacking in respect for individuals who are in formal or informal roles of authority.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Bypass formal lines of authority when necessary to complete tasks.
- Focus more on acquiring and communicating respect by interacting as equals.

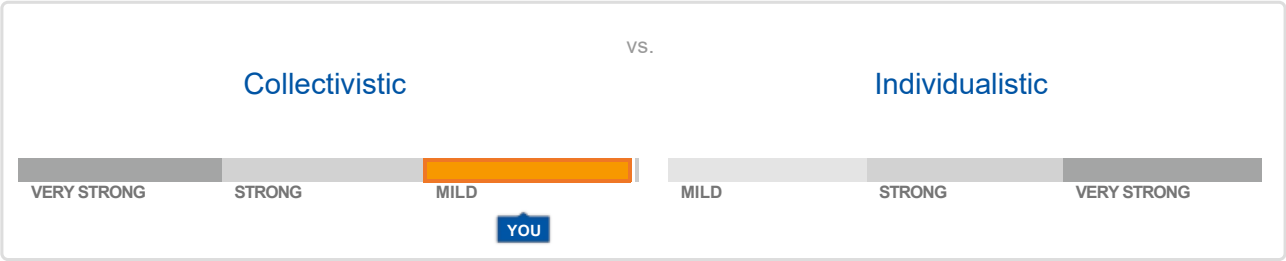
When working with people who have mild equality orientations, you may:

- Feel that they are sometimes too concerned with status and authority.
- Be perceived as too impatient with official titles and forms of address that reinforce hierarchical structures.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Refrain from bypassing formal lines of authority to complete tasks.
- Gain respect through symbols of status or academic achievement.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You identify yourself primarily as a member of a group, which, in the workplace, translates to your team, organization, and/or company. As a result, you are driven and motivated by your affiliation to groups, and/or organizations and readily submit to the norms, practices, and traditions that define such groups and their members. You tend to value interdependence and the subordination of individual interests to those of the group. Particularly, you prefer to be recognized within a group, rather than as an individual, and tend to show group loyalty. Situations in which you are isolated from the group, individually rewarded for your efforts, or have to make decisions by yourself are uncomfortable for you.

You make decisions according to what is best for your organization and determine actions based on their expectations of you. Building group consensus is important to you, and you expect groups and organizations to take care of their members. Open conflict within the group tends to be a negative experience, and you view it as disruptive to group functioning. As a result, you avoid or minimize any potential for its occurrence. You value close interdependence and prize the accomplishment of groups, and you have a sense of social responsibility and obligation.

Challenges

Your mild collectivistic orientation indicates that you are rather flexible in the way that you view yourself in the workplace. While you tend to see yourself as an interdependent part of a group, you also find it easy to style-switch and accommodate a more individualistic, independent approach.

When working with people who have mild individualistic orientations, you may:

- Minimize the differences inherent in your respective preferences for being part of a group or an independent agent at work.
- Be unprepared to deal with the impact of differences in how you prefer see yourself in the workplace, particularly in stressful situations.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Be aware of the subtle ways in which differences in cultural preferences may become apparent.
- Build on your ability to easily style-switch and willingness to compromise to improve your work relationships.

When working with people who have strong or very strong individualistic orientations, you may:

- Feel that they are too focused on their individual benefits, contributions, and achievement.
- Perceive them as resistant to necessary conformity with the group's norms and practices.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Put your interests before those of the group.
- Feel comfortable acting on personal motives or in your own interest alone.
- Use cultural dialogue to negotiate and set expectations regarding "fitting in" and prioritizing the group.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

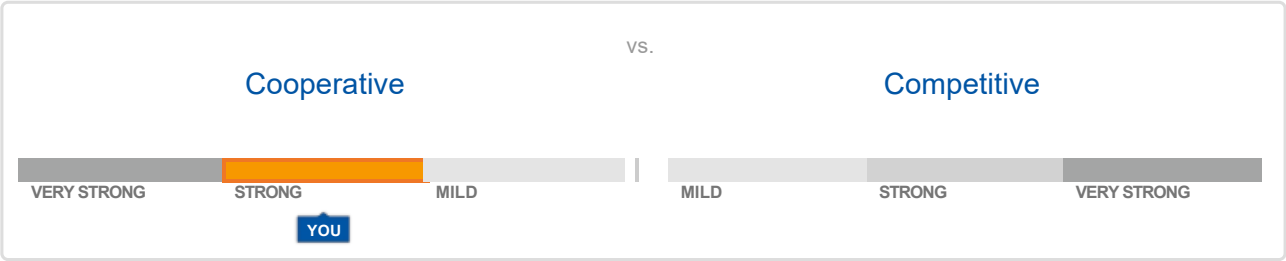
When working with people who have strong or very strong collectivistic orientations, you may:

- Become frustrated by what you perceive as a work environment that sometimes stifles individuality and self-expression.
- Feel that they can require excessive submissiveness to group norms, consensus, and conformity.
- Expect unrealistic sacrifices for the benefit of the group in certain contexts.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Seek deeper understanding of how their affiliation to a group motivates them and connects to their sense of identity.
- Use cultural dialogue to negotiate and set expectations regarding "fitting in" and prioritizing the group.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You are motivated by life balance, quality, and mutually understanding and supportive relationships in workplace and business relationships. You are motivated by and seek to establish qualitatively good, interdependent, even familial, relationships with others who are mindful of the respective needs involved. This may also entail that you forego actions or rewards that do not benefit all stakeholders and/or team members.

Establishing and maintaining balanced and satisfactory relationships are basic drivers for you that outweigh the benefits of strictly focusing on results, recognition, and/or rewards. You expect to build solid relationships with work associates and team members. It is important to you to maintain and nurture long-term relationships built on trust, mutual reward, and a more complete recognition of the needs involved.

Challenges

Your strong cooperative orientation indicates that you generally find mutually beneficial and supportive work relationships motivating in the workplace. In general, you find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more competitive, achievement-oriented approach.

When working with people who have competitive orientations, you may:

- Find them too focused on achievement, accomplishments, external recognition, and symbols of success.
- Be frustrated by colleagues who see themselves in personal competition with you.
- Be unmotivated by their focus on dominating and beating competitors.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Understand more deeply the role of external symbols of success in motivating them.
- Style-switch to engage and appeal to their achievement orientation.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong cooperative orientations, you may:

- Be perceived as confrontational at times.
- Feel that their focus on mutual benefits and supportive relationships is excessive in some cases.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Develop even greater tolerance for motivation based on supportive relationships.
- Consider more carefully the potential impact of your goals and needs on others.
- Demonstrate your concern and consideration for others more visibly.

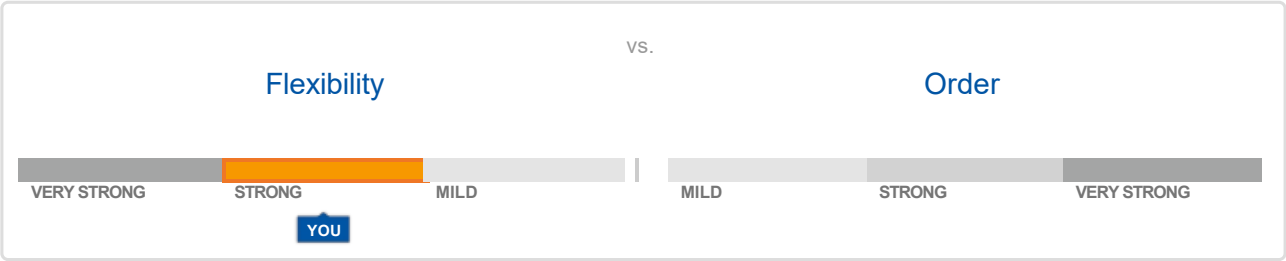
When working with people who have mild cooperative orientations, you may:

- Be perceived as overly concerned for mutual support and benefits at times.
- Be seen as underestimating the need for achievement and external symbols of success.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Balance the benefits of mutually supportive work relationships and achievement-oriented actions.
- Consider the advantages of occasionally acting based on personal interest.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.



Debrief

You have a tolerance for ambiguity and uncertainty. You expect the conditions of your work to change and are willing to adjust your behavior, activities, and priorities accordingly. Therefore, you can accommodate needed changes and adaptations and appreciate semi-structured or entirely unstructured situations in business interactions. You tend to value and strive for innovation and adaptability.

You tend to view change and risk as an opportunity for growth. You are not threatened by shifting parameters or unpredictable and ambiguous situations. You are comfortable in situations that require you to take risks, improvise, or be spontaneous. Situations that are tightly structured and prescriptive, including role definitions, procedures, processes, schedules, and agendas, tend to be uncomfortable for you.

Challenges

Your strong flexibility orientation indicates that you tend to tolerate higher levels of ambiguity, uncertainty, and unpredictability in your work environment. You generally find it difficult to style-switch and accommodate a more order-oriented, risk-averse approach.

When working with people who have order orientations, you may:

- Become frustrated by the need to structure and plan seemingly minor details.
- Feel stifled by the lack of improvisation or spontaneity.
- Think that their need for predictability is excessive.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Adjust to the increased time for preparation that they may need to make change and innovation possible.
- Understand the value to others of preparing for events.

However, you also may experience challenges when working with people who share your orientation.

When working with people who have very strong flexibility orientations, you may:

- Become irritated at times by the lack of structure and predictability.
- Be perceived as sometimes lacking adaptability.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Increase your comfort with uncertainty and unpredictable events.
- Improvise more to take advantage of the creativity that spontaneity can offer.

When working with people who have mild flexibility orientations, you may:

- View them occasionally as having a lower-than-ideal tolerance for ambiguity at work.
- Be seen as insensitive to the stress that change and risk can produce at times.

To address these concerns, you may need to:

- Emphasize the positive aspects of risk and change.
- Increase your comfort with ordered and structured environments.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.

Cultural Orientations

Interaction Style

Orientations that impact how people tend to interact and communicate in the workplace

Fluid:	Loose definition of punctuality; actions determine time.
Fixed:	Precise definition of punctuality; time determines actions.
Being:	Focus on establishing personal, trusting relationships; emphasis on contemplation and reflection.
Doing:	Focus on accomplishing tasks; emphasis on action.
Indirect:	Implicit and/or mediated handling of conflict; emphasis on "saving face".
Direct:	Straightforward and explicit handling of conflict.
Instrumental:	Concentration on factual, detached, and dispassionate style.
Expressive:	Concentration on emotional and/or eloquent style.
Informal:	Emphasis on dispensing with etiquette, protocol and customs.
Formal:	Emphasis on adhering to etiquette, protocol and customs.
Particularistic:	Emphasis on difference, uniqueness and exceptions.
Universalistic:	Emphasis on the uniform application of rules, standards, processes and procedures.

Thinking Style

Orientations that impact how people tend to process information in work situations

Multi-Focus:	Concentration on multiple tasks and/or relationships simultaneously.
Single-Focus:	Concentration on one task at a time; high commitment to schedules.
Past:	Emphasis placed on historical references and traditional ways of doing things.
Future:	Emphasis on projections and references to a distinct vision.
Low Context:	Reliance on explicit and precise communication of meaning.
High Context:	Reliance on implicit and tacit communication of meaning.
Inductive:	Preference for examples, experience and experimentation; reliance on inference.
Deductive:	Preference for theory, concepts and principles; reliance on abstract logic.
Linear:	Focus on the analysis of individual components and points rather than the whole.
Systemic:	Focus on the big picture and causal connections.

Sense of Self

Orientations that impact how people tend to view identity and motivation in work situations

Control:	Value placed on operating with a sense of empowerment in the workplace.
Constraint:	Value placed on operating with a sense of restraint in the workplace.
Private:	Value placed on distance and clearly marked boundaries.
Public:	Value placed on proximity and overlapping, permeable boundaries.
Hierarchy:	Expectation of social stratification and differentiated power structure.
Equality:	Expectation of minimized social stratification and egalitarian power structure.
Collectivistic:	Focus on social affiliation; value placed on dependence; the "we" predominates over the "I".
Individualistic:	Focus on the "self"; value placed on independence; the "I" predominates over the "we".
Cooperative:	Value placed on quality of life and interdependence.
Competitive:	Value placed on material achievement and assertiveness.
Flexibility:	Emphasis on improvisation; value placed on risk-taking and tolerance for ambiguity.
Order:	Emphasis on rules and procedures; value placed on predictability and the minimization of ambiguity.

Cultural Navigator

For more information, visit www.culturalnavigator.com

Cultural Orientations Indicator® is a registered trademark of TMC I A Berlitz Company.

© Copyright 2019 TMC - A Berlitz Company. All Rights Reserved.